

Halden Distribution Ltd. — IT change brief

Change: P1 Core Infrastructure Build (new domain, file services and Group Policy baseline) **Prepared by:** Muhammad Ibrahim Akmal, IT **For:** All staff (via department heads) **Date:** 2026-10-02 · **Change record:** p01-change-record.md · **Planned window:** out of hours, one evening per phase

What is changing

Halden currently runs everything on one aging server. We are replacing it with a proper foundation: two domain controllers (so a single server failure does not stop anyone logging in), a dedicated file server, and a managed desktop policy.

Why it matters to the business

Risk today	After this change
One server does everything — if it dies, no logins, no IP addresses, no files	Two servers share the work; either one can be down without stopping the business
Everyone has Full Control on the shared drive, so a single mistake or virus can destroy any folder	Access is granted by department role. Finance files can only be opened by Finance
Nobody can say who can read Finance or HR data	One permission matrix, kept up to date and approved by the department head
Files deleted by mistake needed an IT call and a restore from tape	Staff restore their own files from "Previous Versions" in under a minute

What staff will notice

1. **New drive letters** appear automatically when you log in, based on your department (F: Finance, H: HR, S: Sales, O: Operations, G: Company-wide reading).
1. **You will only see the folders you are allowed to open.** A folder you cannot access is no longer visible at all, so the shared drive looks shorter and tidier.
1. **Passwords must be at least 14 characters** and accounts lock for 15 minutes after 10 wrong attempts. This is a deliberate security control, not a fault.
1. **Your screen will lock after 10 minutes** of inactivity. Press any key and sign back in.
2. **Home drives** are available on a hidden share; each person can only open their own folder.

What staff need to do

- **Nothing on day one.** Sign in as normal; the new drives appear by themselves.
- **If a drive is missing,** sign out and back in once (`Ctrl+Alt+Del` → Sign out). If it is still missing after that, raise a ticket with the Service Desk — do not try to map it by hand.
- **If you believe you are missing access** to a folder you need, ask your **department head**

first: they approve access, not IT (see the permission matrix).

- **If you cannot log in at all**, call the Service Desk. Please have your staff ID ready.

Who to contact

Situation	Contact
Missing drive, cannot sign in, file restored incorrectly	IT Service Desk (ticket)
Need access to a folder for your role	Your department head, then IT on the approved request
Anything urgent or business-stopping	IT Service Desk by phone, marked "urgent"

Rollback

Every phase was snapshotted before it ran and each change is reversible; if a phase had to be reversed, the previous working state is restored from the snapshot the same evening. No user data is deleted by this change.